2. The types of information shared with others—raw intelligence or intelligence that has been processed in some form
3. The distinction between bona fide intelligence bodies and bodies that do not belong to the intelligence community
4. Information that is relevant to or needed by the law enforcement system, as opposed to information that is not
5. Hierarchical criteria—in the United States, for example, which information is transferred at the federal level and which at the state or municipal levels; also, which information goes to which branches of government, executive, legislative, and/or judicial
6. The types of information shared with allied or friendly countries and with foreign intelligence services

Sometimes the political-strategic reality creates strange bedfellows. In the Middle East, some of these odd partnerships were created at the initiative, or with the involvement, of the UN. One of the positive differences between the UN and its predecessor, the League of Nations, is the military force that the UN can employ in order to quell conflicts between states. These forces can act as a buffer between combat forces or as a liaison between the parties. In the Middle East conflict, these forces often served as an intermediary to establish ties between Israeli intelligence and security forces and their counterparts in neighboring Arab countries; the degree of intensity of these ties reflected the magnitude of the two sides' common interests. The lowest level of cooperation occurred when the parties' mutual desire was simply to preserve calm on both sides of the border. The highest level of cooperation was achieved when both sides found themselves facing a common enemy, whose potential to cause harm to both sides was greater than the potential for hostilities between the two. An example of the first case is the arrangement made to maintain quiet on Israel's borders with Syria and Lebanon. An example of the second case is the cooperation between Israeli security and intelligence bodies with their counterparts in the Palestinian Authority in the face of the threat of Hamas and Islamic Jihad (though it is difficult to know whether this cooperation will last if there is a real agreement to put an end to the rivalry between the PLO, which still controls the Palestinian Authority, and Hamas, which controls Gaza). Another example in this category is Jordan, which, decades before the